

TRANSFORMATION OF THE LOWER SELF; SUMMARY OF THE YEAR'S WORK

Blessings, greetings, love, and help are pouring forth in a wonderful golden stream that permeates your inner being and that your outer personality can connect with if you so choose. My dearest friends, in this last official lecture of your working season, once again I will give a résumé of what you have accomplished. Of course this can only be done in an overall, general way, but I will try to consolidate your progress in "a final point," so to speak. This past -- what you call in your terms "year" -- has been very meaningful for all of you.

At the end of last year, in a similar summary I told you that after having recognized and dealt with deeper levels of your lower self, you will be able to establish contact, to a certain degree, with your higher self and that some of the lower self aspects will be transformed. This was a decisive new phase on your path since previously the work was hard and grinding to get through the defenses so as to really see and accept the lower self -- accept it in realism and in a constructive spirit. Years went by before the first steps of transforming work could begin. And the last year, in the time segment just past, was the first step in this new phase on your path. So, indeed, it has come to pass, as most of you are well aware of in yourself -- whoever is in this position -- and also among your dear friends. You see it in each other with all your critical faculties intact. It cannot escape you. So, the transforming work has begun, but it is just a beginning. It will continue to a much greater extent as you continue to develop on your path. You may imagine what this means in terms of ever increasing joy, love, peace, security, strength, creativity, deep friendship, and unity. Even these first steps of transforming work have so changed your relationships, your experiences, your community, your sense of well-being and meaning in life. You are often startled by this change. It seems sometimes miraculous. Yet it is a mere beginning, and so much more of it is to come.

The increasing abundance that you experience as a result of your pathwork, inwardly and outwardly, gives your life a much more specific focus and awareness of your incarnatory task. It also manifests in your relationships together and among each other, in the community you have begun to establish. You see a visible change where before there was often so much strife, dissension, disconnection, misunderstanding, and negativity among you. More and more do you experience understanding and warmth together, acceptance and love and true friendship. You have learned to a considerable degree to successfully deal with the dissensions that are sometimes inevitable. You recognized that dissension among each other is merely a reflection of the dissension within yourself. You put into practice what I taught you in all these years: as you unify yourself, so do you unify your relationships with others. As you recognize the best and the worst in you in proper proportion, so do you recognize the best and worst in others with equal realism.

The progress is obvious. What were previously words teaching a way of living that could exist as your reality if you followed the path, what was a beautiful sounding theory or philosophy for you has now become a reality. The theory has indeed been put to the test. The result is visible. You do

not even need to be particularly perceptive in order to see and to make comparisons and to realize what you are about to create.

In this past time span you have experienced a great deal together. You have learned to open yourself to one another. You have lost a considerable amount of shame and resistance against baring yourselves to one another. And thus the loneliness you all suffered from begins to disappear, sometimes in giant steps. For you now know that your loneliness can never be relieved by another person's love as long as you stay in your shameful hiding and separation, as long as you keep up your pretenses. This separation and these pretenses have been laboriously stripped off to quite an extent by many of you. And to that very same extent you find yourself in warm communion with others, no longer lonely. So you truly begin to share. You have shared sorrow, and you have shared joy. You have shared your doubts in yourselves and in your lives. You have shared your pain about yourselves and each other. You have shared your burdens of guilt. And you have begun to share the pleasures of love and truth. For there could be no greater pleasure than sharing love and truth as a result of the other sharing. You have tasted the exhilaration of such rich living. You now know what I am talking about, and yet this is just the beginning. You can indeed create paradise on earth if you do not shy away from the labor of purification work. But soon the work itself becomes the exhilaration and the joy. It ceases to be painful and difficult. You find this out also as you move on.

That is the work you must continue. You have made a wonderful beginning in this transforming work, but much, much more is to come. And as more transforming work will take place, so will you, individually as well as a community, create more real, deep, beautiful living together, more sharing, more creative experiences, more meaningful fulfilling of yourself. More and more will your spiritual self manifest and make you experience its eternal reality. More and more will you become the nucleus of a new culture, as I have occasionally hinted at. You are pioneers. Other groups of pioneers spring up in various corners of the earth, each in their own way, each what it should be.

As you overcome more and more your resistances and you learn not to give in to the line of least resistance, so do your joys and your deep awareness of the meaningfulness of your life and of your task increase. I have said such words often, but they were more an announcement of what could be. Now it is different. For many of you these words are a living reality that you experience right now in your life from day to day. And this reality can become deeper and stronger if you so choose.

So the last lecture of this time segment will, in a different and yet similar way as the first lecture of the new time segment, give you a plan and another intensified tool of how to go further in this transforming work. This requires new understanding on a deeper level. What I will say is particularly applicable to where you are now and would make little sense if you had not yet arrived at this point. So the topic of this lecture will be further advice about transforming work. And transforming work will become easier after the understanding I shall try to convey to you. Again, of course, I ask you to bear with me if some of the things I say must be repetitious. But the full context of the lecture could not become clear unless I occasionally and unavoidably made such repetitions.

You, my friends, who have gone into the depths and have bared aspects of the lower self, bringing the negative intentionality out into the open where you can express it, expose it, see it for

what it is, have learned in this process, on the positive side, that it frees you. You can acknowledge these aspects without becoming cast down and believing that this is the true you. Quite on the contrary, you experience the truth I have always given you: when those negative intentions are secret, even from your conscious mind, you also secretly believe that you are all bad. This manifests in self-destructive patterns that you do not understand and cannot trace to their origins unless and until you have the courage and honesty to first bare the negative intentionality specifically. Then, lo and behold, something unexpected begins to happen. You accept and respect yourself more and know that this is only a minor part of your total self. You can identify aspects of the lower self without totally identifying with them.

On the negative side you have found out that in these lower self aspects resides a senseless stubbornness that still controls you to a degree and in an almost incomprehensible way. In your thinking, clear mind, you know perfectly well that it does not make sense to hold onto a negative intention. You have experienced in other areas the bliss and the safety to let go and let God. You also begin to make the connections conscious, and you see what a price you pay for the persistence in the negativity. Yet you do not wish to abandon it. You are puzzled by your own attitude. And here you are stuck.

Why do you persist in the life-denying attitude? That attitude in you says no to giving in to the meaning of life, to beauty, love, truth, expansion, joy, and peace. It refuses to surrender to God. This attitude always applies to a specific area where the lower self does not wish to budge. It is therefore not enough to make your good will known to your consciousness in a general, overall way. It must be specific in this or that trait or area.

Wherever this strange, mysterious stubbornness prevails, you are still controlled by your lower self. But at least you know it now, and that is an important step. You do need help here, my friends, precisely at this point where quite a few of you have arrived. If you bother to deal with this attitude rather than gloss over it, rationalize it away, make yourself oblivious of its existence, you come to an important point. You see but fail to understand this truly senseless behavior of a part of yourself, and you even see that you have chosen not to do battle with it. You have just given in and become victimized by your own lower self.

But this need not be so. When you can begin to ask yourself questions about this, then you have already made another substantial step in the right direction. For example, questions like this: "Why do I refuse to surrender to God and give up what I know to be happiness, abundance, bliss? Why do I settle for the puny satisfaction of my spite, my destructiveness, my selfishness (or whatever it may be)? What is it in me that makes me so destructive? How much do I really pay for just allowing it to happen? Isn't there a way to change this inner course? Why, knowing the beauty of life, do I still deny it? Why can I not affirm life and God and the flow of creativity?" These questions will lead to answers and to clarifications. They must be asked and taken seriously. They puzzle all those who arrive at that juncture.

This lecture deals with these questions. I have often mentioned, my friends, that there is a countermovement in you. There is one movement that embraces life, that affirms life, that wants that which is divine. And there is a countermovement that denies all that. It wants to remain in darkness in spite of the obvious pain that this inflicts. It wants to insist on living life on its own terms even though its terms are life-denying and destructive for self and others. This

countermovement has its history in the process of creation of the ever forth-flowing substance of life penetrating the infinite void and thus bringing eternity and light into the non-life and the darkness of the void -- until the void no longer exists. The time will come (to speak in those limited and confusing terms for lack of others in your dimension) when there will only be light and life.

Substances of consciousness -- and with the consciousness, of course, energy, the two being inseparable aspects of the eternal life spark -- get lost from their source, as it were. The substance spreads (I used this analogy in various lectures, in different contexts), and in the spreading it temporarily separates itself from the whole. In that separation it is to find, through its own inner life spark, all the inherent godliness. It has to battle its way through the darkness and distortion that are by-products of the separateness. So, temporarily these aspects of consciousness and energy -- individualities -- turn sour. They invert themselves. They turn into anti-matter, anti-consciousness, anti-energy. This is why there must be struggle to reawaken divine matter, divine consciousness, divine energy.

From all the beauty, creativity, and goodness, this inversion creates ugliness, destruction, and evil. There have been many names for this countermovement throughout history. Those names can become obstacles in dealing with evil, for they often have been misused in a further inverted way. They were used to dominate, to judge, to punish, to put down, to instill fear of life and God, to make a primitive charade out of the wonders and miracles of ongoing creation. Therefore people turn a deaf or resistant ear to terms such as good and evil, God and the devil, heaven and hell, and many others. Yet these expressions merely describe in a symbolic way a state of consciousness that is very difficult to convey to a consciousness still steeped in a three-dimensional world. Thus we, from our world, constantly seek ways and words to convey to you facets of reality without eliciting reactions that would be inappropriate and thus would limit your understanding. However, there exists an unavoidable limitation. The vocabulary, as you know it, is limited, so you must fulfill your own part in the mutual venture of learning. Just as I grope to find the words best suited to a specific topic, so must you grope not to allow prejudices and word associations to create a wall that would prevent you from taking in what I give you. For what I give you is a potent tool for your further development. Do not close up to a truth I am privileged to help you perceive, even if you occasionally hear a word that usually evokes a negative reaction in you.

Evil exists in degrees. Consciousness and energy aspects are personified in entities or individualities, in personalities, in living beings who have their separate aspects both of divinity and of evil. The strength with which the former can penetrate the ego structure and manifest depends on the degree the latter has been transformed throughout the evolutionary development. Many different varieties of distribution and intensity exist of manifest divine and evil and of their relationship with one another.

There are spheres of reality where the contrasts are infinitely greater than the spheres of reality that you express in your state of development, and therefore "inhabit." In the highest developed spheres and states of consciousness, the degree of goodness, greatness, brilliance of spirit or mind, of beauty, wisdom, and love is totally beyond your present imagination. By the same token, there are spheres of (temporary) reality and states of consciousness in which the ugliness, the brutality, the cruelty, the feelinglessness, the limitation of mind (though there exists shrewdness, as opposed to wisdom), the hatred, the smallness of spirit are equally beyond your imagination. These separated beings -- you might call them sub-humans -- exist in a world of such darkness that there indeed

seems no way out until, as a result of long suffering and groping, the mind turns and starts thinking and expressing itself in a different, new way. This is the key. A key that seems too simple to accept for those who are in the state of evil and suffering and who want to insist that to turn around is a very complicated process impossible to accomplish. The consciousness and energy in these states are so condensed and thickened that they are "more" matter than the matter you know so that, to you, this matter is as imperceptible as the finer matter of higher developed consciousness and energy. Consciousness and energy always create substance: matter and form according to their own nature and state. To your human senses at your present state of development, the higher and the lower states of consciousness and energy are equally imperceptible.

In this lowest state of development, evil is so strongly on the surface that it is completely unaware of the divine nucleus. There actually does not seem to be an inherent divine nucleus. Only through eons and ages of development does the nucleus finally become apparent, but at first only very dimly.

The human state of development is an in-between state. There are various beings of various degrees of development incarnated and fulfilling themselves in other states. These degrees of development may seem to fluctuate considerably from your point of view, especially if you pick extreme representatives from either end of the scale. Nevertheless, neither the highest nor the lowest degrees exist in the human state. You do not know the full extent of good and evil because your field of inner vision does not reach these levels.

The foregoing may seem to indicate that creation is split in dualism, something I always deny in my lectures and teachings. As I will prove to you on a very practical level, in essence the split does not really exist. But on a level of temporary manifestation, it does exist and must be dealt with and recognized for what it is.

There is hardly any human being whose lower self could approach the intensity of the evil that exists in the so-called lower spheres. And the now manifest higher self could not by any means approach the intensity and beauty of the true, divine, eternal existence. I would also like to add here that manifest evil is not always and necessarily an indication of an overall lack of development. It is often quite the contrary. The active, virulent evil often indicates that the potentiality to develop the divine aspects has been willfully neglected so that the potent energy currents of the consciousness invert themselves and manifest equally potently in a negative way. The spiritually really immature and "young" appear in the human sphere quite often as innocuous, ineffectual, primitive minds -- the herd mentality that runs with the masses and does not think independently. This is why a severely disturbed human being who exhibits some evil traits but who already has a developed conscience and therefore does not act out evil deeds, turns relatively quickly into a spirit of light and of power for the good once the mind has truly been affected.

The distortion of separation from the divine essence is only temporary. It cannot last. It is a process of filling the void, and sooner or later through the ages, that distorted, inverted, separate "piece" of consciousness and energy, that separate personality must be "filed," purified through experiences of living, through increasing perception until its essence is rediscovered. And that is the process of the ongoing development and evolution.

These things have been said, sometimes in oversimplified terms, by various religions. But do not forget, my friends, that religions, when they first appear, are channels that somehow communicate divine truth to humanity. They are later often distorted. They may be flattened out because the mind becomes lazy and ceases to work. It prefers handed-down rules and generalizations that may or may not apply to the inner state. Even the truth of a spiritual law becomes a superficial statement when it is not independently found through the process of self-confrontation and search, but instead is lazily accepted on the surface in order to avoid the labor and risks involved in personal growth. This is why religions lose their power of truth after a while, but they often start as channels of truth. All this must be avoided here and will be avoided here as long as you stay dynamically involved in your pathwork, in your search and personal growth.

The reason I tell you this now, my dearest friends, is to make it clearer to you what your life really means in these terms. You, your higher self, has taken on a task and has "taken with it," -- if I may use this expression, into an embodiment, into a materialization, an aspect of that anti-God matter with its inverted consciousness and energy. You have taken it with you into incarnation where it is possible for you, as your task, to get to know it, to deal with it, to influence it, rather than be influenced by it.

This aspect has its own separate will, as you find out to your bafflement and dismay. That is the point where you often get confused and stuck: that there are indeed separate wills and thinking processes in you. Your consciousness, your personality as it is in the world must make choices, including which of the wills to follow. You can choose to allow the will of that lower self to control the whole person. Or you can choose to take over and have your conscious mind, your conscious will, ally and align itself with the higher self and not suppress and repress, not push the lower self with its will, with its voice, out of your awareness. You also need to think about what it means when you just go with the lower self without doing anything about it; when you still have the temptation to rationalize it and do nothing to challenge the lower self's will.

Now, in none of you is the lower self anywhere near as intensely destructive as what I indicated before. But the lower self is always destructive, otherwise it would not be a lower self. It may be destructive in wanting to be malicious or selfish or ungenerous. It is destructive by persisting in its limiting view: that what is selfish is good for the self. It is destructive by very simply refusing the total self-surrender to divine consciousness and divine will within you at every turn of your way. You forget to do this. You do not trust this surrender even if you have already experienced the blissfulness of it -- here or there. But your forgetting is not really forgetting. It is a deliberate intent of that "other" will and consciousness you carry with you. Your outer mind always has a choice to fall prone to it, to be controlled by it, to allow it to rule you. But you can also take the reins into your hands, to be aware of that "other" will, to confront it, to counter it, to not allow it to destroy your life and waste valuable life substance and creative expression. It does not have to make you miss out on the blissfulness of eternal life that increasingly filters through into your life now.

This point is the most crucial one now for your further and intensified transformation work. You do not "cast out" any devils. That is a misunderstanding of some religious orientations. When the devils are cast out, you do not perform the task of transforming. You may succeed in casting out devils, but the devils live on, maybe not attached to you, but they live on. Your lower self can be transformed, and you have seen this happen, my friends. It is happening increasingly. This lecture is geared to give you still better tools at this particular point, tools that you could not have

used before you came to this specific awareness, the awareness that could be expressed like this: "Here I see myself wanting to be destructive. I see the pain it causes me, the senselessness of it. I know that it need not be that way. Yet I want to go on being destructive. I do not want to give up my pride, my self-will, my fear, and put them into the service of God." That is the peculiar, puzzling point. It is so puzzling to many people that they soon push it aside again and act as if it were not there. Then you take this in-between, half-aware, half-awake state for granted.

I shall try now to explain as exactly as is possible with the tools at my disposal what happens when consciousness and energy are being transformed. That, too, will give you light, incentive, and greater motivation to put all of your conscious being into the service of the divine consciousness that dwells deep within you.

In a lecture I have given this past year -- it was an extra-curricular lecture, I believe around your Christmas time -- I gave you examples of what the positive, divine aspect is behind each specific negative manifestation. You have asked me what positive aspects the specific negativities are distortions of, what the original divine aspects or attributes were. I have gone through a number of them to give you a good idea how to continue meditation whenever you face a lower self aspect. You have forgotten to pursue this approach, so you often elaborate longer than necessary on the purely negative manifestation.

When you begin to see these areas of your lower self, it is very important that your conscious mind begins to think about "what is this trait in its original beautiful version before it is inverted, distorted, made negative?" You can truly meditate about it and thus not allow the negative to rule you. In that way you do not cut out, but transform or transmute. You neither allow those aspects to take over and rule you, nor do you cast them out and separate yourself from them. You truly fulfill the task for which you have come.

Let us say that it is your stubbornness that resists to deal with this aspect of self-work, that resists surrender to the divine kernel. Could this stubbornness not be retained in a positive way and be transformed as a positive manifestation of your Godself? If you do not have to cast it out, you will not be so resistant because you may use this transformed stubbornness in a new and different way. If you find yourself being selfish, if you believe you must cast out the selfishness, it will be impossible for you to even want to approach and cross the threshold where you seem to be stuck. But if you know that there is a healthy selfishness that you have every right to pursue and that does not exclude giving and loving and being generous, then the resistance will wane, and the devil in you will turn into an angel in this particular area.

Most of you, my friends, have forgotten this very important tool I have given you and have not consciously used it. But the fact that I gave it to you indicated that you were ready for it and that part of your unconscious processes began to use them, took them in when I talked about them, so that the progress mentioned in this respect is now well under way. But your conscious application of these tools will make you even more ready for the universal abundance available to you as a result of your transformation work. Begin to do it now more consistently in a more focused way.

You now know quite clearly that your inability to stand the ever-increasing pleasure in your life, so that you often still feel compelled to destroy it, is due precisely to this dilemma. This is why

you cannot find your way to transforming negativity. Once you begin to solve it, you will experience the glory of this work. What was once negative, destructive, and even outright evil will turn into positiveness, constructiveness, and sheer goodness. What was once a conflict, an either/or will become a unification. For example, instead of seeing unselfishness versus selfishness, you will truly see that there is a healthy selfishness, good at certain times, and there is a time to be unselfish, and that, too, is good. It is very important to specifically apply this approach to all areas you deal with. This way consciousness transforms while it stays intrinsically its own unique, individual divine manifestation. It does not change its essence, it only changes its expression. Therefore, in experiencing and knowing this, the resistance will lessen and lessen, for you will not fear that you will lose something intrinsically you. And you will experience that that aspect of you that can decide the course of your attitudes, that can redirect expression of consciousness is the "more valid you," if I may use this strange and awkward expression. At the same time, the other part that you are about to transform will become more and more like an appendix that you have taken with you in your task to fulfill yourself. Consequently, as you do this transforming work, a unification occurs. In the process of feeling yourself increasingly more unified and conflict-free, you will fully discover the intensity and pain of the conflict you have labored under for so long. Often on the path you see fully only when the ill is about to disappear. What was once a conflicting "other," even though incarnated in your own soul substance, becomes one with the divine in you.

The energy must change equally. The energy that is an emanation of the lower self is a very slow-moving energy. It is often a halted energy, condensed and heavy. Energy can be perceived with all the senses, but only on a level the conscious mind is not aware of, as a rule. Lower self energy is extremely unpleasant.

As far as the visual sense perception is concerned, some of you can perceive to some slight degree energy emanations. People have sometimes perceived the differences in energy emanations -- in color, in brightness, in the pleasing aspects of the hues. The difference is very obvious. The lower self energy emanation is either dull or crass. The color expression gives off distinct unpleasant reactions, while the higher self emanations in their color, in their brilliance convey peace, harmony, joy, and bliss. Perception of color on the level of spiritual reality is not cut off from, but is always connected with and expresses and communicates attitudes.

Energy also has an auditory expression, but human beings do not hear it. The sounds of an emanating consciousness, if the entity is highly developed, are extremely beautiful and harmonious. The sounds of a lower self are disharmonious, ugly, displeasing to the inner ear.

The same goes for all the other senses. The fragrance of purified consciousness is incredibly beautiful, such as you cannot imagine. The odor of impure consciousness is equally unpleasant; it can be a stench.

On the touching level, energy is felt by other energy bodies. The energy of the higher self is felt as soft, nurturing, vitalizing. You perceive and bathe in the energy emanation of purified consciousness. But the touch perception of distorted, inverted, negative consciousness is painful in every possible way. It can be cutting or scratching or itching or pinching. Many different kinds of pain can be experienced, according to the specific turn of the attitude expressed behind the energy emanation.

There are many other senses that you do not know of and that I can therefore not discuss. However, this will give you an idea that a personality with its inherent attitudes expresses itself in energy, and this energy conveys those attitudes in every sense imaginable. In your dualistic sphere of consciousness, what you see, hear, smell, or touch is most of the time apparently quite disconnected from attitudes and energy emanations that are extremely personal and specific. Everything is hacked up, separated, and manifests in a disjointed, disconnected way. This is often confusing for the personality. It gets tired of these separations. Therefore it strives sooner or later into a more unified state of consciousness where what is perceived is not separated from the essence, even if it temporarily manifests in negativity and inversion.

So you see, my friends, when you experience a very beautiful, highly elevated, joyous state, you must know that your energy system, whether your conscious mind knows it or not, perceives all these energy emanations on all these sense levels that I talked about. But when you are unhappy, heavy, depressed, your own energy system unites with the similar energy system of others -- whether they are in the body or not. Your energy body is influenced by the sights, the sounds, the odors, the touching, and the many other sense perceptions of others. There is a cross-fertilization. Your negative state influences others in a similar state, and vice versa, each feeding the other. What your energy body experiences is not clear in the outer mind; the outer mind merely registers displeasure, anxiety, heaviness.

When you transform negative consciousness, you also transform negative energy. Your life will be an ever increasing and extending beauty. It will be, it already is, like a blossom that unfolds in ever greater splendor. As you overcome each hurdle of the lower self, as you commit yourself forever more strongly to the divine will in you, so will this blossom unfold into fruition, into never-ending and always increasing fruition. So you never need to fear an end, for there is no end.

Be blessed, my dearest ones, be in peace.

For information to find and participate in Pathwork activities world wide, please write:

The Pathwork® Foundation
PO Box 6010
Charlottesville, VA 22906-6010, USA
Call: 1-800-PATHWORK, or
Visit: www.pathwork.org

The following notices are for your guidance in the use of the Pathwork® name and this lecture material.

Trademark/Service Mark

Pathwork® is a registered service mark owned by The Pathwork Foundation, and may not be used without the express written permission of the Foundation. The Foundation may, in its sole discretion, authorize use of the Pathwork® mark by other organizations or persons, such as affiliate organizations and chapters.

Copyright

The copyright of the Pathwork Guide material is the sole property of The Pathwork Foundation. This lecture may be reproduced, in compliance with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy, but the text may not be altered or abbreviated in any way, nor may the copyright, trademark, service mark, or any other notices be removed. Recipients may be charged the cost of reproduction and distribution only.

Any person or organization using The Pathwork Foundation service mark or copyrighted material is deemed to have agreed to comply with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy. To obtain information or a copy of this policy, please contact the Foundation.